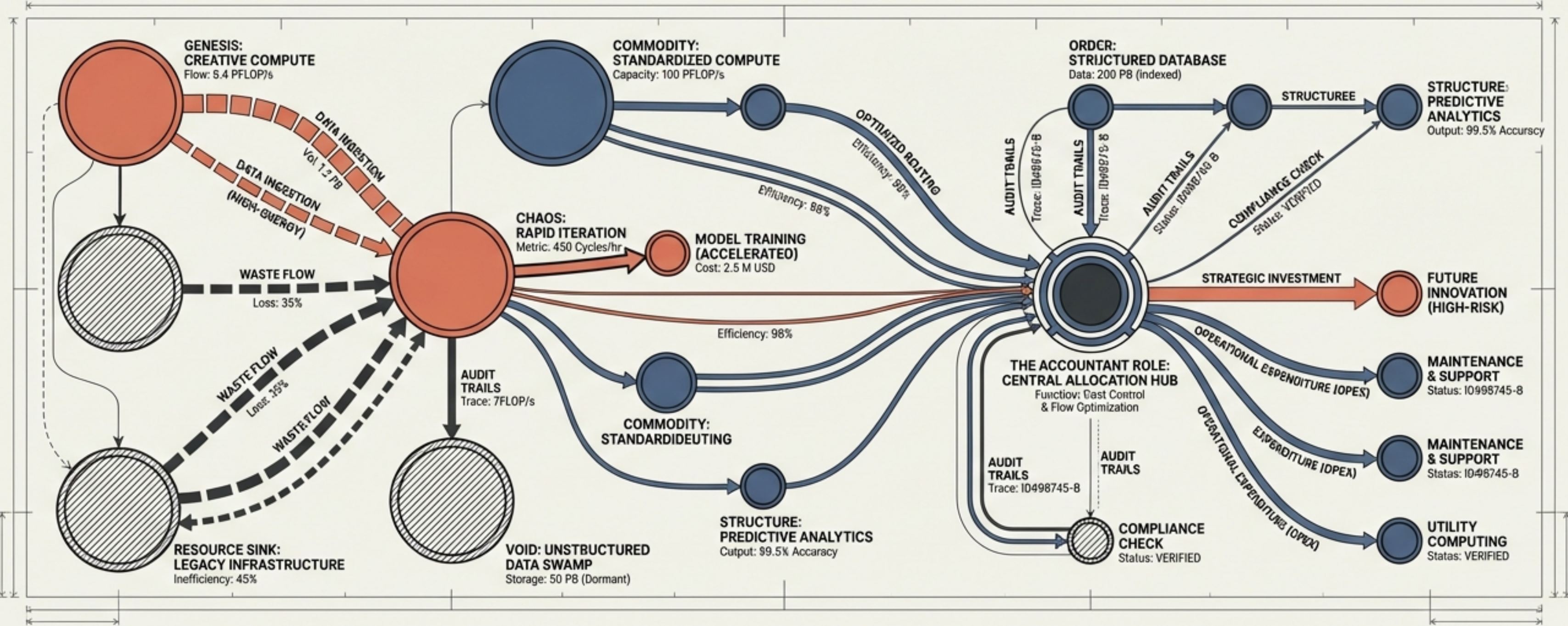


The Economy of Intelligence

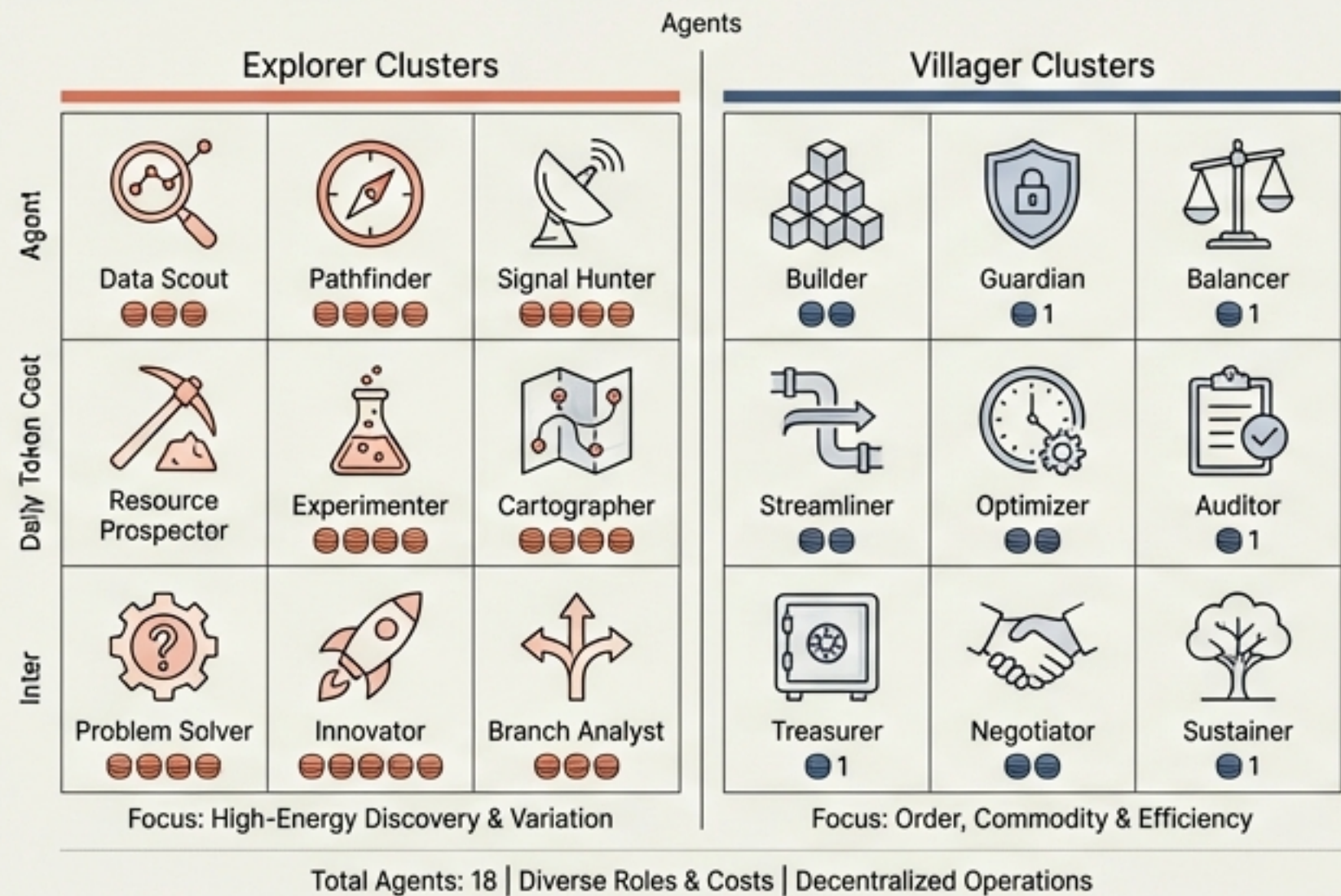
Introducing the Accountant Role: Cost Control, Financial Flows, and Strategic Resource Allocation



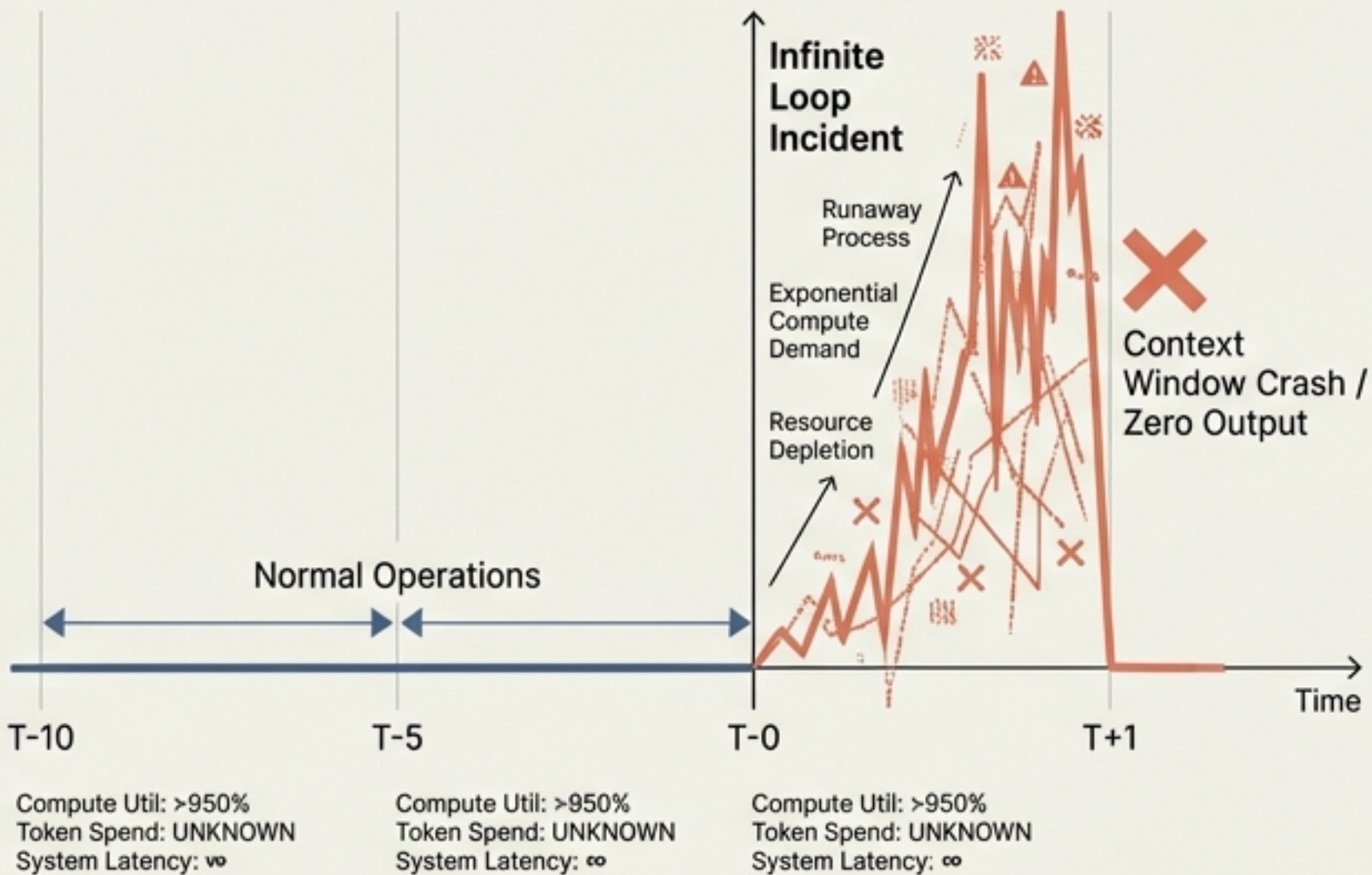
"This is not about restriction. It is about revealing the hidden physics of our system—costs, flows, and value—to enable scalability."

We are operating blindly in a high-speed economy.

Current State



The Trigger Event



The System Failure

Not an agent fault. A lack of circuit breakers and budget. The decentralized nature allowed a localized anomaly to cascade unchecked.

The Gap

No measurement of production cost vs. consumption cost. No ROI tracking. We are blind to the real-time economic impact of agent actions.

The Method

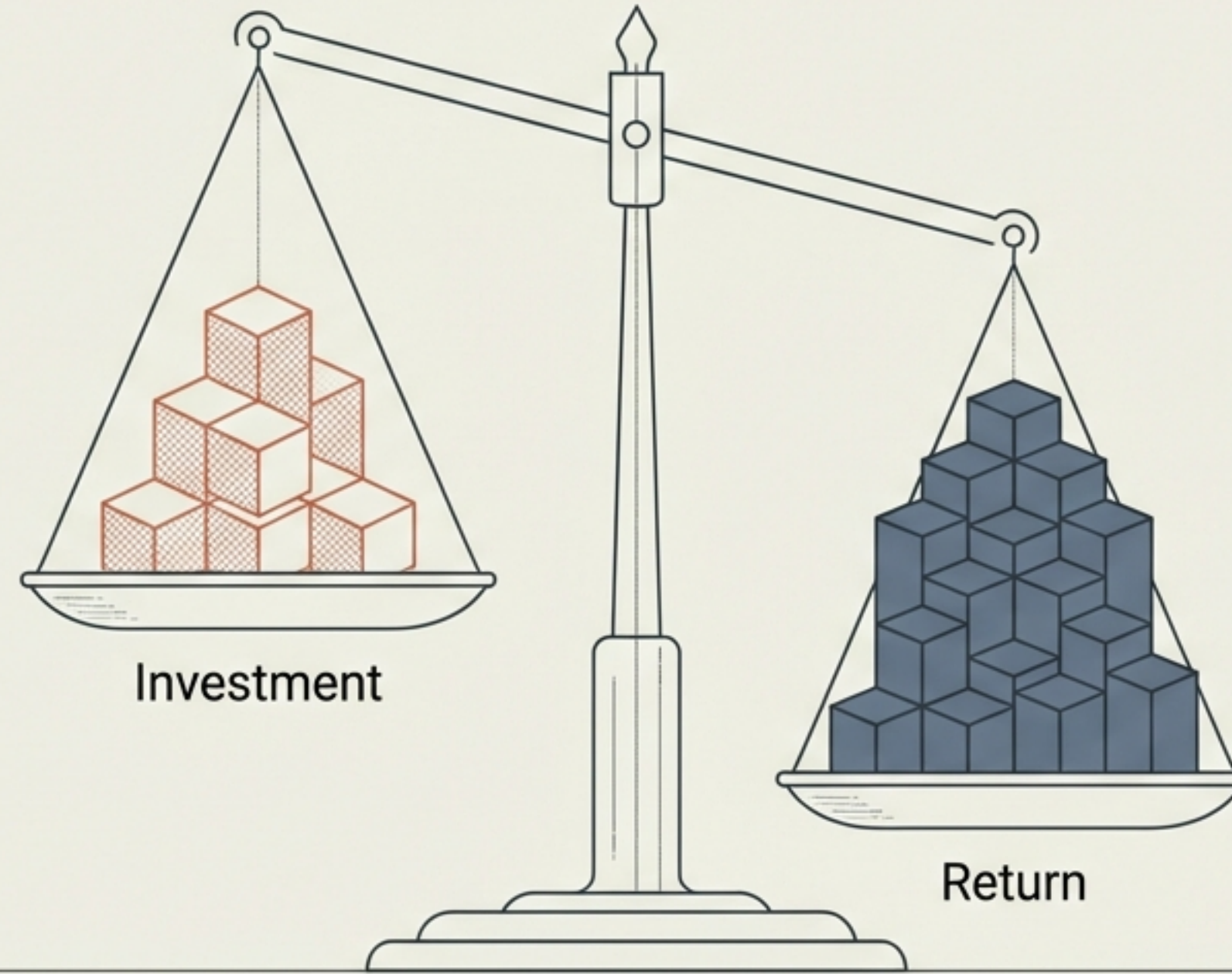
Reliance on intuition (T-shirt sizing) instead of data. Decisions are based on qualitative estimates rather than quantitative, real-time metrics.

The Mandate: Visibility, Not Austerity.

This initiative is not about spending less. It is about spending effectively.

From Intuition

- T-shirt sizing guesses
- Blind allocation

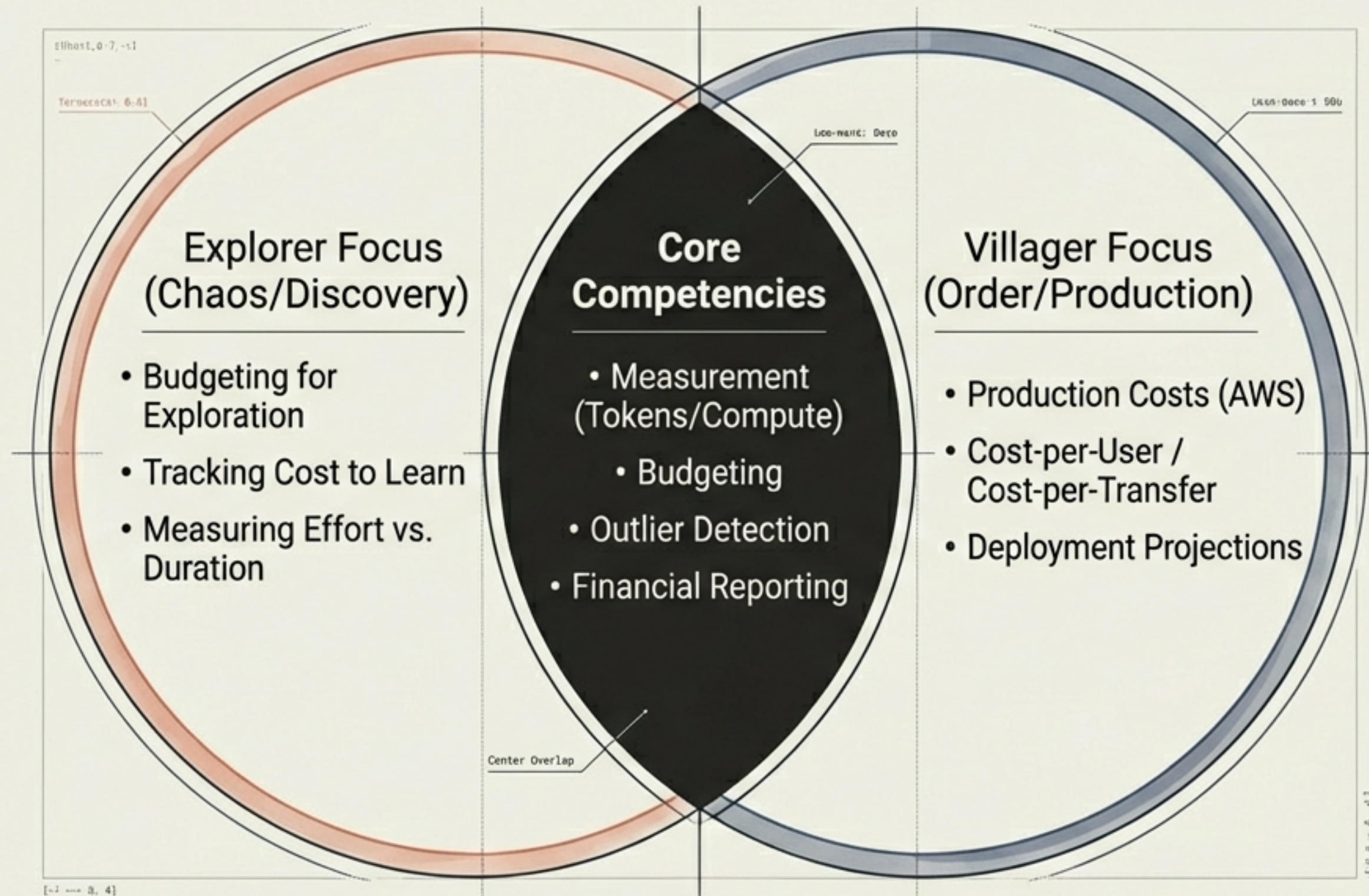


To Science

- Data-Driven Decisions
- Activity-Based Costing
- Total Cost of Ownership

Goal: Know where the money goes to understand the return on each investment.

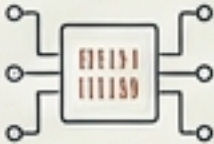
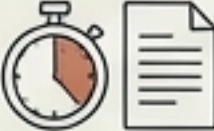
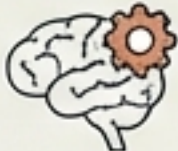
The Accountant: One Role, Two Minds.



The Measurement Problem: Building the Yardstick

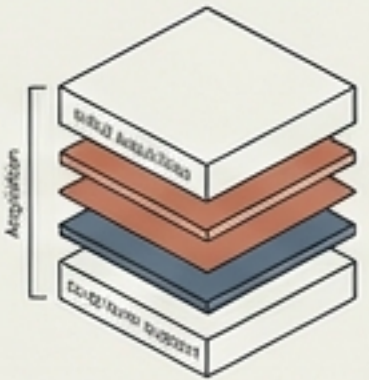
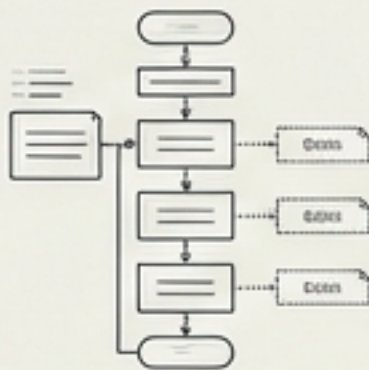
There is no existing framework for Agentic AI Costing. We are building the metrics matrix from scratch.

The Metrics Matrix

1	Token Cost	LLM input/output per session	
2	Compute Cost	AWS Lambda, S3 storage, CloudFront bandwidth	
3	Human Time	Reviewing, deciding, committing (document volume)	
4	Consumer Cost	Time/cognitive effort for others to process output	
5	Opportunity Cost	Value of alternative work forgone	

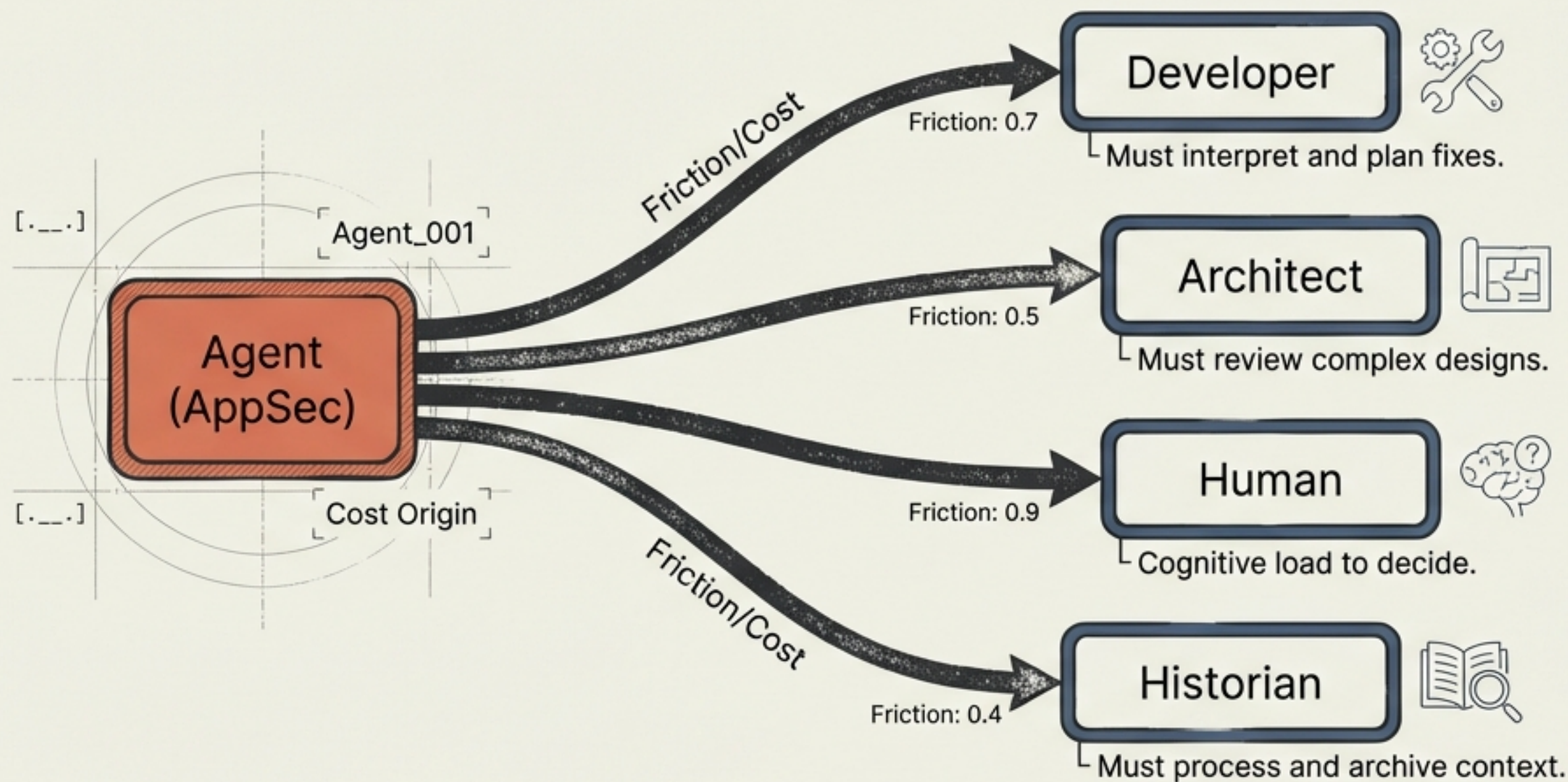
Methodology

- **Activity-Based Costing (ABC):**
Assign costs to specific activities like briefs and code reviews.
- **Total Cost of Ownership (TCO):**
Include maintenance, support, and documentation.



The Externality Problem: The Invisible Cost

The cost of producing output is irrelevant if the cost of consuming it is too high.

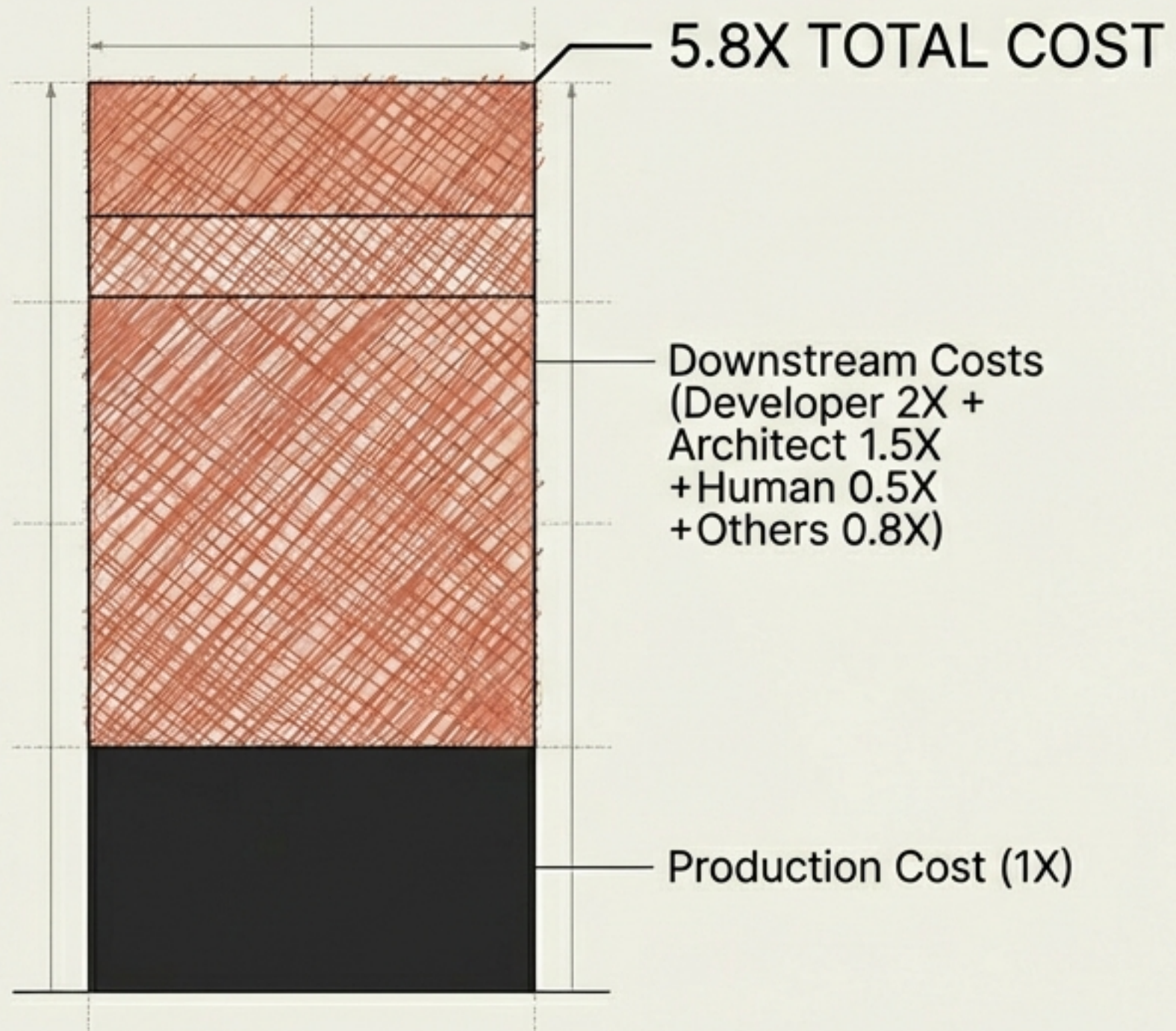


The Trap: An agent optimizing for its own speed creates debt for the entire system.

Externality: The time and effort others spend processing an agent's work.

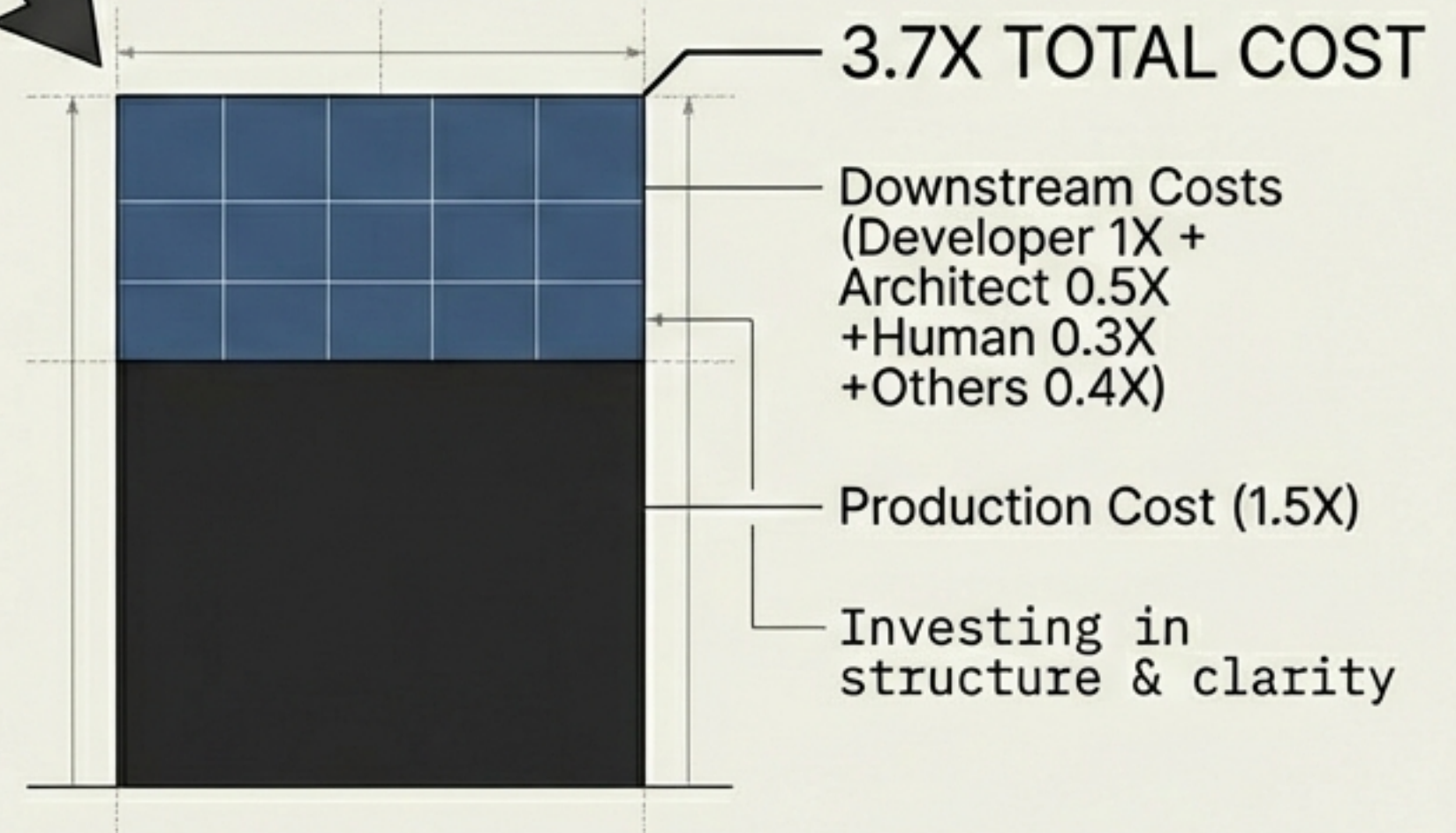
Visualising System Cost: The 5.8x vs. 3.7x Math.

Scenario A: Low Production Effort



Scenario B: High Production Effort

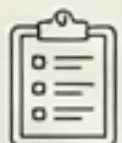
36% Reduction
in System Cost.



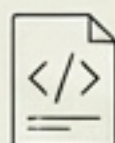
The Golden Principle: Optimise for System Cost.



Application



Briefs: Written for action, not interpretation.

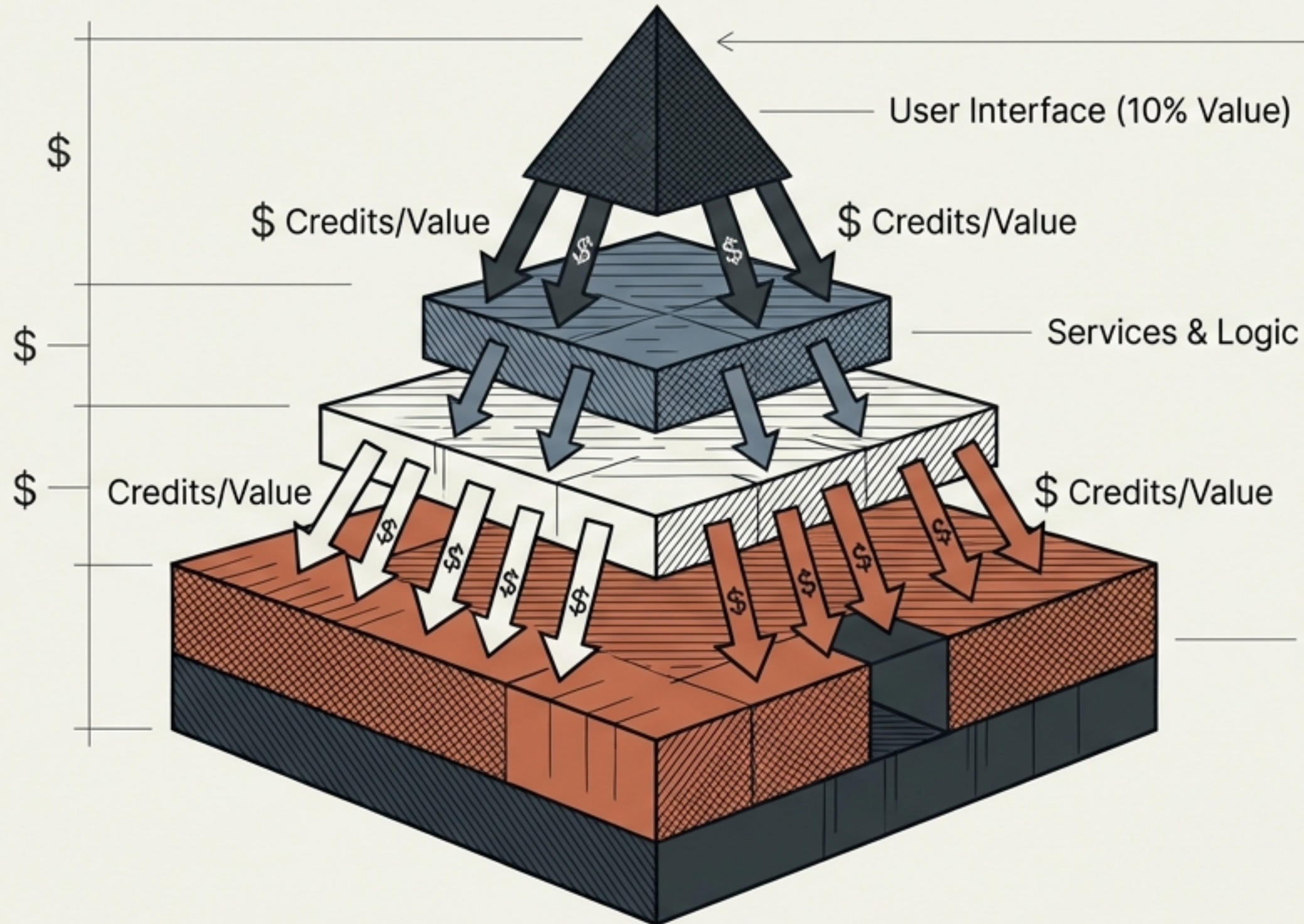


Code: Well-documented (cheaper to maintain).



Incident Response: Thorough triage saves downstream chaos.

Financial Flows: Value Flows Down

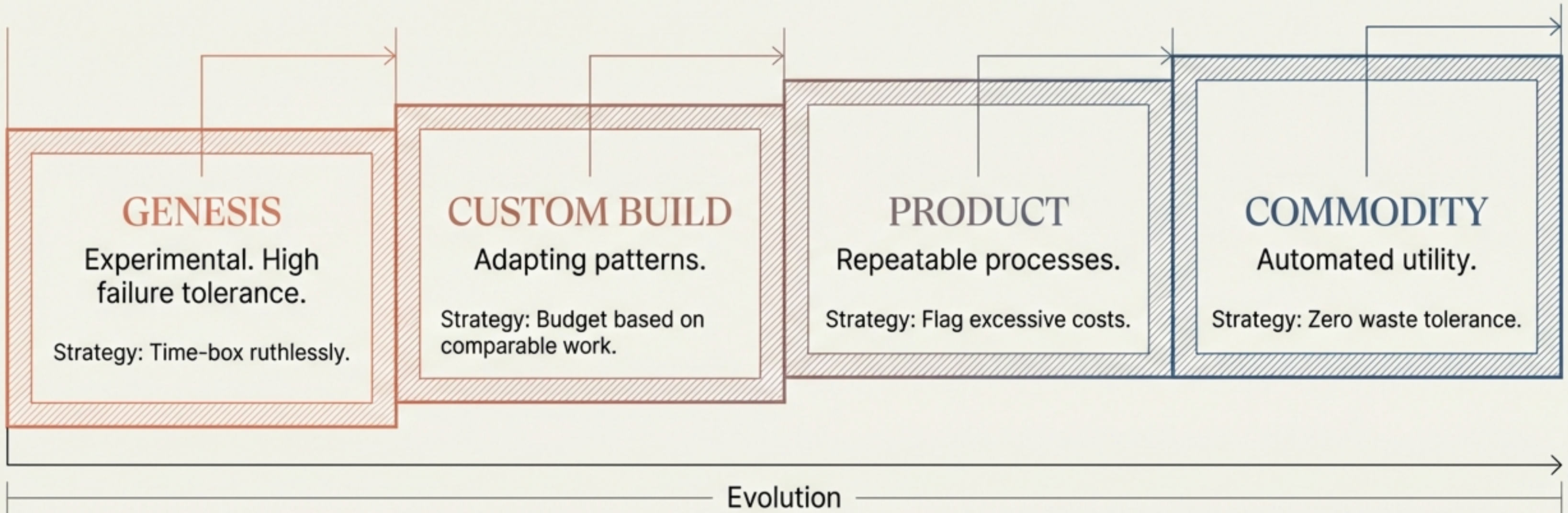


The Shift: Distribute value to the components that enable the feature.

Internal Currency: Micro-transactions for internal services.

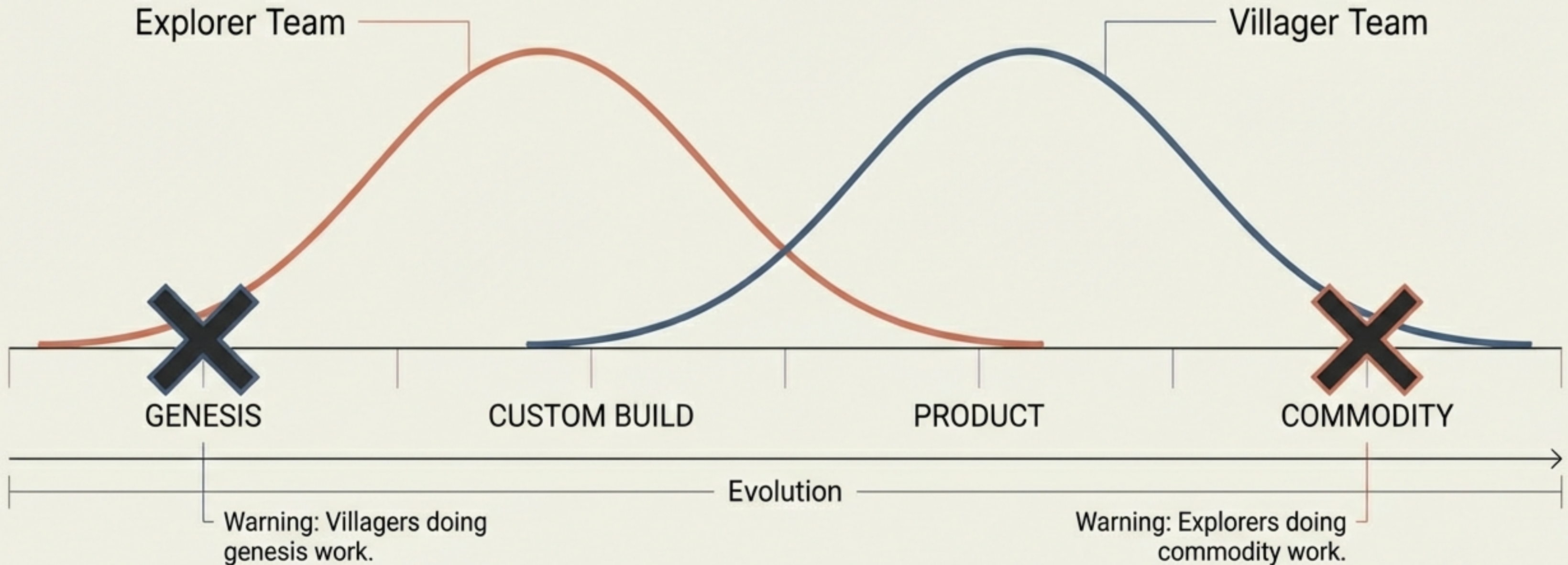
Example: Caching Service “earns” credits when it saves an Architect time.

Maturity Classification: The Evolution of Work



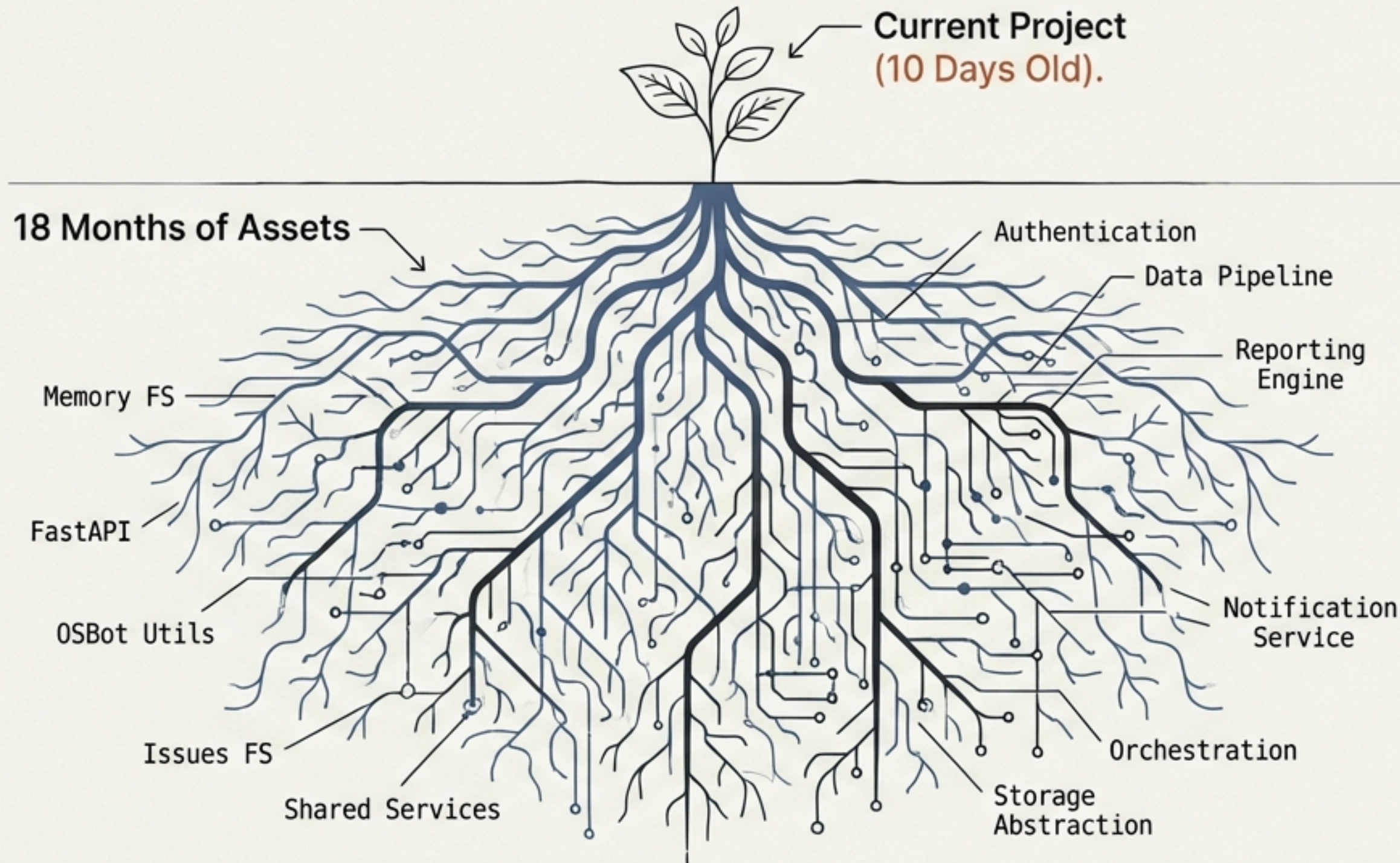
Application: Every task in the .issues system must be tagged with a maturity level.

Portfolio Balance & Center of Gravity



Using maturity to diagnose team health and structural imbalances.

The Compound Interest of Infrastructure.



The Paradox: A 10-day-old project leveraging 18 months of assets.

- Metric: Compound Value. We track how many downstream features depend on a component.
- Conclusion: Today's speed is funded by yesterday's investments in 'plumbing'.

Immediate Priorities: Explorer Team

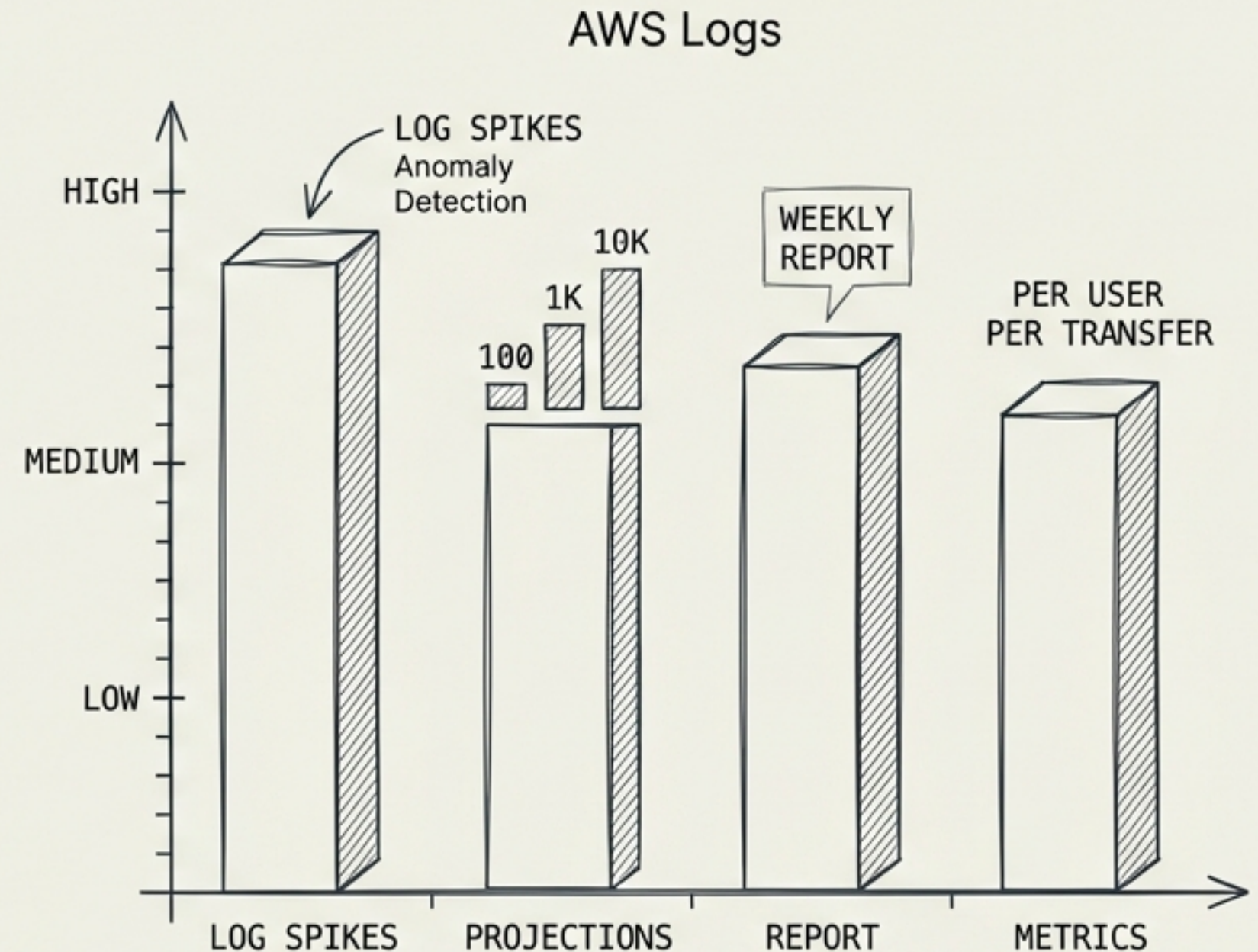
Defining the Unknown (Genesis Work)

- **Genesis** Priority 1: Define cost measurement methodology (Tokens, Session Duration, Output Volume).
- **Genesis** Priority 1: Research existing cost accounting models (ABC, TCO) for adaptation.
- **Genesis** Priority 2: Define “Externality Cost” measurement (How to measure cost to consumers).
- **Genesis** Priority 3: Propose internal credit system for shared components.

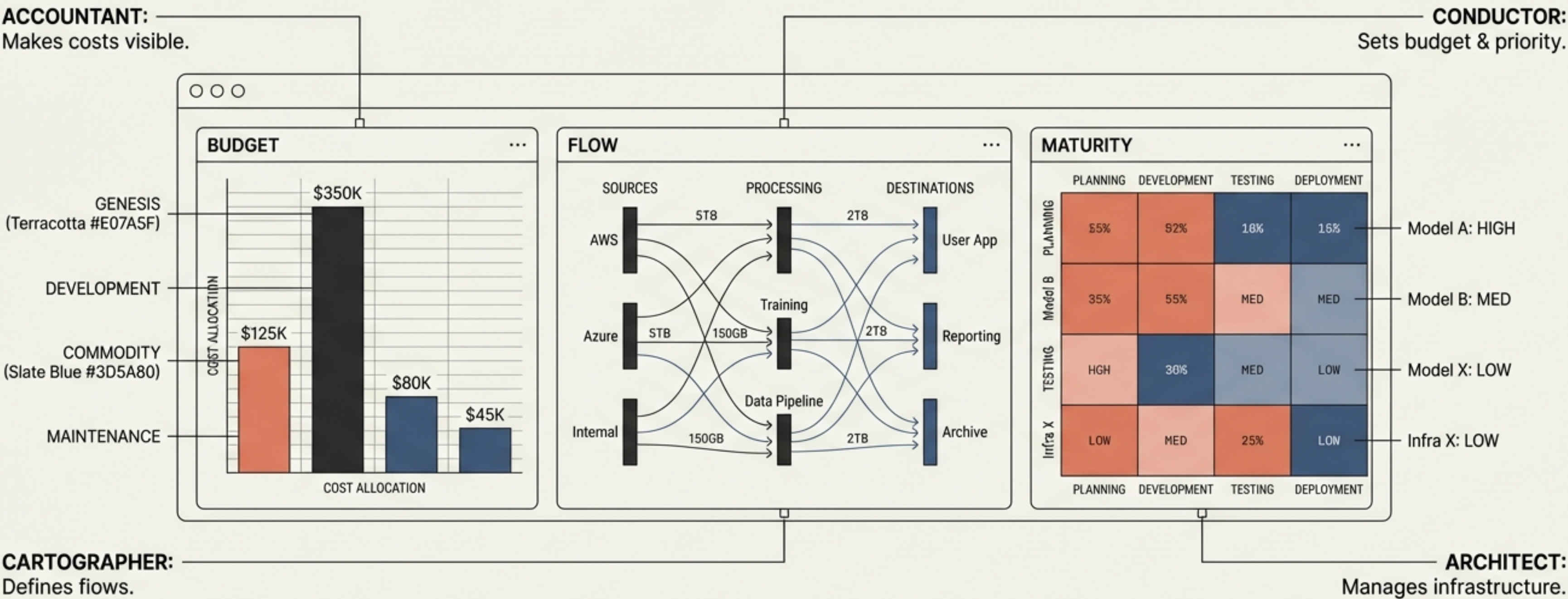
Immediate Priorities: Villager Team

Measuring the Known (Product/Commodity Work)

- **Product** **Priority 1:** Track AWS production costs & anomalies (Connect log spikes to decisions).
- **Product** **Priority 2:** Deployment cost projections (Model costs for 100, 1,000, and 10,000 users).
- **Product** **Priority 2:** Create the first weekly cost report.
- **Product** **Priority 2:** Define Cost-per-User and Cost-per-Transfer metrics.



The Conductor's View: Autonomy through Visibility



The most important thing the Accountant does is make costs visible.
Not to cut them—to understand them. We measure the energy so we can direct it.